

2026 RACE GUIDE

40 OPEN ENTRY RACES, NO QUALIFIER

20 in California, 20 across the US, all USATF certified. From summer 2026 through spring 2027, a window for whatever you're building toward. For the runner who lifts and the lifter who runs.

THE RULES OF THIS LIST

It's race season. If you've been waiting for the right moment to sign up for something, this is it. 40 open entry road races: 20 in California, 20 across the US. All USATF certified. All open to everyone, no matter how fast or slow you run.

The rule for everything in this guide: **no qualifying time, no lottery**. You register, you train, you show up. Races run from now through spring 2027, so there's a window for whatever you're building toward.

Prices go up as race day gets closer. A handful of these are sold out of standard entries but still have charity or benefactor spots. We've flagged the status on every one. Click through and verify before you register. Race capacity and pricing move fast.

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- 01 **Open entry:** no qualifying time required. Pay the fee and you're in.
 - 02 **USATF certified:** course distance is officially measured. PRs count.
 - 03 **Status flagged:** Open, Limited, or Sold Out, accurate as of August 2026.
 - 04 **Verify before you register:** capacity and pricing can shift between updates.
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20 CALIFORNIA RACES

OPEN ENTRY · SUMMER 2026 TO SPRING 2027

01 BEER CITY HALF, ALAMEDA

ALAMEDA, CA · JULY 10, 2027

[Check site](#)

www.alamedapint.com

Flat, fast, USATF certified Bay Area waterfront course. Good summer tune-up option. Craft beer at the finish. The 2026 race is done. Registration for the 2027 edition opens December 1, 2026.

5K · 10K · Half Marathon

● 2027 REGISTRATION OPENS DEC 1

02 THE SAN FRANCISCO MARATHON

SAN FRANCISCO, CA · JULY 24-25, 2027

[Check site](#)

www.thesfmarathon.com

Golden Gate Park, across the bridge, through the city. The 2026 race is run, 30,000 finishers across the weekend. Next one is the 50th anniversary edition and registration is already open.

5K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● 2027 REGISTRATION OPEN

03 NAPA TO SONOMA WINE COUNTRY HALF

NAPA, CA · JULY 18, 2027

[Check site](#)

www.runnapatosonoma.com

Point-to-point through active vineyards, Cuvaision Estate to Sonoma Plaza, with the Rosé 5K on the plaza the day before. The 2026 race is run. The 2027 waitlist is open now and gets you early access pricing plus registration 48 hours before everyone else.

Rosé 5K (Saturday) · Half Marathon (Sunday)

● 2027 WAITLIST OPEN

04

SANTA ROSA MARATHON

SONOMA COUNTY, CA · AUG 22-23, 2026

From \$114

santarosamarathon.com

Wine country roads, mostly flat, multi-distance weekend. Half and full marathon are both sold out. The 5K and 10K on Saturday may still have room.

5K · 10K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● 5K/10K OPEN · HALF & FULL SOLD OUT

05

CALIFORNIAN DREAMIN' HALF MARATHON

LONG BEACH, CA · AUG 23, 2026

From \$49.75

runsignup.com/Race/CA/LongBeach/CalifornianDreaminKHalfMarathon

Coastal SoCal course from Venice to Long Beach. Three distances starting under \$60. Beach finish in August. Hard to beat this value for a certified coastal half.

5K · 10K · Half Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

06

BEER CITY HALF, BISHOP RANCH

SAN RAMON, CA · SEP 12, 2026

Check site

runsignup.com/Race/CA/SanRamon/BeerCityBishopRanch

East Bay edition. Multi-distance format with a 1-mile option. USATF certified. Good fall training block tune-up.

1 Mile · 5K · 10K · Half Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

07

2XU LONG BEACH MARATHON

LONG BEACH, CA · OCT 10-11, 2026

From \$139

www.runlongbeach.com

One of SoCal's most consistent fall race weekends. City streets and coastline. Half and full marathon are sold out — join the waitlist. October in Long Beach is as close to perfect race conditions as SoCal gets.

5K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● 5K OPEN · HALF & FULL SOLD OUT

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TWO CITIES MARATHON

FRESNO/CLOVIS, CA · NOV 1, 2026

Central Valley fall classic. Multi-distance, USATF certified, point-to-point. Smaller field, less hype, faster moves through registration.

5K · 10K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

Check site

www.run2cm.com
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SILVERADO HALF MARATHON & 10K

SILVERADO, CA · NOV 7, 2026

Orange County wine country, canyon roads, fall race day. Less crowded than the big city events. Certified, open entry.

10K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

Check site

www.runguides.com/california/runs/half-marathon/all
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SANTA BARBARA HALF MARATHON & 5K

SANTA BARBARA, CA · NOV 8, 2026

Presented by HOKA. 13.1 along the coast plus a 5K and kids fun run. Sold out four weeks early in 2025. Expected to sell out earlier in 2026.

5K · Half Marathon

● OPEN · SELLING FAST

Check site

santabarbarahalf.com
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MONTEREY BAY HALF MARATHON

MONTEREY, CA · NOV 8, 2026

Sold out in eight days. One of the most beautiful half courses in California. Charity and Race Benefactor spots are the path in.

Half Marathon

● GENERAL SOLD OUT · CHARITY SPOTS OPEN

Charity: \$350+

www.montereybayhalfmarathon.org
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BERKELEY HALF MARATHON

BERKELEY, CA · NOV 15, 2026

USATF certified East Bay course winding through Berkeley campus, downtown, and the marina. Mid-November race day with full fall conditions.

Half Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

Check site

berkeleyhalfmarathon.com

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CALIFORNIA INTERNATIONAL MARATHON

SACRAMENTO, CA · DEC 6, 2026

Net downhill, point-to-point, USATF and World Athletics certified. One of the fastest marathon courses in the US. All standard tiers sold out at record speed. Gold Entry Draw closed in May.

Full Marathon

● **SOLD OUT · CHECK CHARITY OPTIONS**

\$230 (Gold)

runsra.org/california-international-marathon
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SAN DIEGO HOLIDAY HALF MARATHON & 5K

SAN DIEGO, CA · DEC 19, 2026

13.1 with a 711-foot net elevation drop along a rolling downhill bike path. A fast December half and a way to end the year with a PR attempt.

5K · Half Marathon

● **OPEN REGISTRATION**

Check site

www.sandiegoholidayhalf.com
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CARLSBAD MARATHON, HALF & 5K

CARLSBAD, CA · JAN 17-18, 2027

Coastal SoCal race down Carlsbad Boulevard with Pacific views for most of the course. Registration open early for the lowest pricing of the year.

5K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● **OPEN REGISTRATION**

Early bird pricing

inmotionevents.com/event/carlsbad-marathon
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SURF CITY MARATHON & HALF

HUNTINGTON BEACH, CA · FEB 2027

Pacific Coast Highway through Huntington Beach on Super Bowl Sunday. Coastal, fast, surfboard finisher medal. Annual; 2027 dates expected to be announced.

5K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● **2027 REGISTRATION**

Check site

www.runsurfcity.com

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LOS ANGELES MARATHON

LOS ANGELES, CA · MARCH 2027

Stadium to the Sea, Dodger Stadium to Santa Monica. One of the most iconic point-to-point marathon courses in the country. Open entry, no qualifier.

Full Marathon

● 2027 REGISTRATION

[Check site](#)
www.lamarathon.com
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MOUNTAINS 2 BEACH MARATHON & HALF

OJAI TO VENTURA, CA · APRIL 2027

Net downhill from Ojai to the Ventura coast. Known as one of the fastest BQ marathon courses in California. Annual; 2027 registration opens fall 2026.

Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● 2027 REGISTRATION

[Check site](#)
www.mountains2beachmarathon.com
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HOAG OC MARATHON RUNNING FESTIVAL

COSTA MESA, CA · MAY 2027

Annual SoCal weekend with marathon, half, 5K, and combo challenges. Course finishes at OC Fair & Event Center. Open entry, multi-distance.

5K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● 2027 REGISTRATION

[Check site](#)
ocmarathon.com
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ROCK 'N' ROLL SAN DIEGO

SAN DIEGO, CA · MAY 2027

Balboa Park start, finish in Little Italy, live music every mile. Annual SoCal classic. 2027 registration opens late 2026.

5K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● 2027 REGISTRATION

[Check site](#)
www.runrocknroll.com/events/san-diego
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20 US CERTIFIED RACES

NO QUALIFIER · ALL USATF CERTIFIED

- 01

TUNNEL LIGHT MARATHON

NORTH BEND, WA · SEP 13, 2026

Net downhill point-to-point through the old Iron Horse rail tunnel and along the Snoqualmie Valley Trail. USATF certified. Cult favorite for PR attempts. Storm damage closed sections of the usual course, so 2026 runs an alternate permitted route. Registration closes September 6.

Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● OPEN · CLOSSES SEP 6

Check site

www.tunnelmarathon.com
- 02

LIFE TIME CHICAGO HALF MARATHON & 5K

CHICAGO, IL · SEP 27, 2026

Big-city feel without the lottery. Welcoming crowds, energetic course support. USATF certified. Open registration, no qualifier.

5K · Half Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

Check site

www.chicagohalf.com
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TWIN CITIES MARATHON

MINNEAPOLIS-ST. PAUL, MN · OCT 4, 2026

Consistently called the Most Beautiful Urban Marathon. Lakes, parks, fall foliage, city streets. Open entry, no lottery, no qualifier. Register and go.

10K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

Check site

www.tcmevents.org

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HARTFORD MARATHON & HALF MARATHON

HARTFORD, CT · OCT 10, 2026

Flat, fast, USATF certified. A popular Boston qualifier attempt course because the consistency is that good. Open registration, rarely sells out early.

Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

[Check site](#)
hartfordmarathon.com
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STEAMTOWN MARATHON

SCRANTON, PA · OCT 11, 2026

Point-to-point, significant net downhill, USATF certified. Runners who are serious about a PR target Steamtown specifically for the course profile. Small field. Open entry.

Full Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

[Check site](#)
steamtownmarathon.com
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BALTIMORE RUNNING FESTIVAL

BALTIMORE, MD · OCT 17, 2026

26th annual event with a scenic harbor course. USATF certified, open entry, multi-distance. Bring a crew at different fitness levels.

5K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

[Check site](#)
www.thebaltimoremarathon.com
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ROCKET MORTGAGE DETROIT FREE PRESS

DETROIT, MI · OCT 18, 2026

International Half crosses the Ambassador Bridge into Windsor and back through the tunnel. Marathon and Motor City Half are sold out. International Half still open through Sep 8.

5K · International Half · 1 Mile

● INTL HALF OPEN · MARATHON SOLD OUT

[Check site](#)
www.freepmarathon.com

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MARINE CORPS MARATHON

ARLINGTON, VA / WASHINGTON D.C. • OCT 25, 2026

No prize money. No elite wave. Just runners. The course goes past the Lincoln Memorial and through D.C. landmarks. General registration sold out. Charity spots open through July 31.

10K • Full Marathon

● CHARITY SPOTS OPEN

\$240 (Military \$225)

www.marinemarathon.com/event/marine-corps-marathon
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CNO FINANCIAL INDIANAPOLIS MONUMENTAL

INDIANAPOLIS, IN • NOV 7, 2026

Flat, fast, USATF certified. Open registration, no lottery, no qualifier. One of the most runner-friendly big-city race setups in the country.

5K • Half Marathon • Full Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

Check site

monumentalmarathon.com
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SAVANNAH SOUTHERN HALF MARATHON & 5K

SAVANNAH, GA • NOV 14, 2026

13.1 through Savannah's historic squares, oak-lined streets, and a finish through Savannah Bananas' Grayson Stadium. Promo code available for \$10 off.

5K • Half Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

Check site

www.southernhalf.com
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ALLIANZ RICHMOND MARATHON

RICHMOND, VA • NOV 14, 2026

Called America's Friendliest Marathon. USATF sanctioned, certified, and a top Boston qualifier course. Full marathon sold out at the fastest pace in event history. Half marathon and 8K still open, waitlist for the full.

8K • Half Marathon • Full Marathon

● HALF & 8K OPEN • FULL SOLD OUT

Check site

www.richmondmarathon.org

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PHILADELPHIA MARATHON WEEKEND

PHILADELPHIA, PA · NOV 20-22, 2026

Full marathon sold out. Half marathon and 8K still open. Certified course through historic Philly. No qualifier for remaining distances.

8K · Half Marathon

● HALF & 8K OPEN · FULL SOLD OUT

Check site

www.philadelphiamarathon.com
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WILLIAMS ROUTE 66 MARATHON

TULSA, OK · NOV 21-22, 2026

Full weekend on the Mother Road's 100th birthday: marathon, half, relay, and 5K through downtown Tulsa. Certified course, open entry, and a finish-line party that earns its reputation.

5K · Relay · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

Check site

www.route66marathon.com
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SPACE COAST MARATHON & HALF

COCOA, FL · NOV 22, 2026

Florida's oldest marathon, 55 years running. Space-themed race day along the Indian River from historic Cocoa Village with a riverfront finish. Full marathon sold out early, the earliest in event history. Half marathon still open but selling fast.

Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● HALF OPEN · FULL SOLD OUT

Check site

www.spacecoastmarathon.com
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BMW DALLAS MARATHON FESTIVAL

DALLAS, TX · DEC 11-13, 2026

55th year. New dynamic pricing model so the earlier you register the less you pay. Multi-distance fall race weekend in downtown Dallas.

5K · 10K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

Dynamic pricing

dallasmarathon.com

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JAL HONOLULU MARATHON

HONOLULU, HI • DEC 13, 2026

No qualifier, no cutoff time, ages 7 and up. The course runs from Ala Moana through Waikiki, around Diamond Head, and back. Bucket-list December marathon.

Merrie Mile • 10K • Full Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

Check site

www.honolulumarathon.org
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CHEVRON HOUSTON MARATHON WEEKEND

HOUSTON, TX • JAN 15-17, 2027

Aramco Houston Half on Sunday Jan 17. Flat, fast, USATF certified. Registration runs Nov 1, 2026 through early January.

5K • Half Marathon • Full Marathon

● 2027 REGISTRATION

Check site

www.chevronhoustonmarathon.com
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CHERRY BLOSSOM TEN MILE

WASHINGTON D.C. • APRIL 2027

Tidal Basin, cherry trees in peak bloom, ten flat miles. Annual lottery for general entry; charity bibs available. USATF certified.

5K • 10 Mile

● LOTTERY + CHARITY ENTRIES

Check site

www.cherryblossom.org
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CRESCENT CITY CLASSIC 10K

NEW ORLEANS, LA • APRIL 2027

One of the oldest 10Ks in the country. Course goes through downtown New Orleans, the French Quarter, and Esplanade Ave. USATF certified. 2027 registration open.

10K

● 2027 REGISTRATION OPEN

\$55 to \$80

ccc10k.com

NYCRUNS BROOKLYN SPRING HALF

BROOKLYN, NY · APRIL 25, 2027

Prospect Park loop course. NYCRUNS runs a clean operation: easy bib pickup, USATF certified, no lottery. The Brooklyn half marathon without the Brooklyn half wait list.

5K · Half Marathon

● **2027 REGISTRATION**

Check site

brooklynexperience.
com

**RUN. LIFT.
SWEAT.**

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